# Comparative Dravidian Morphology: An Overview

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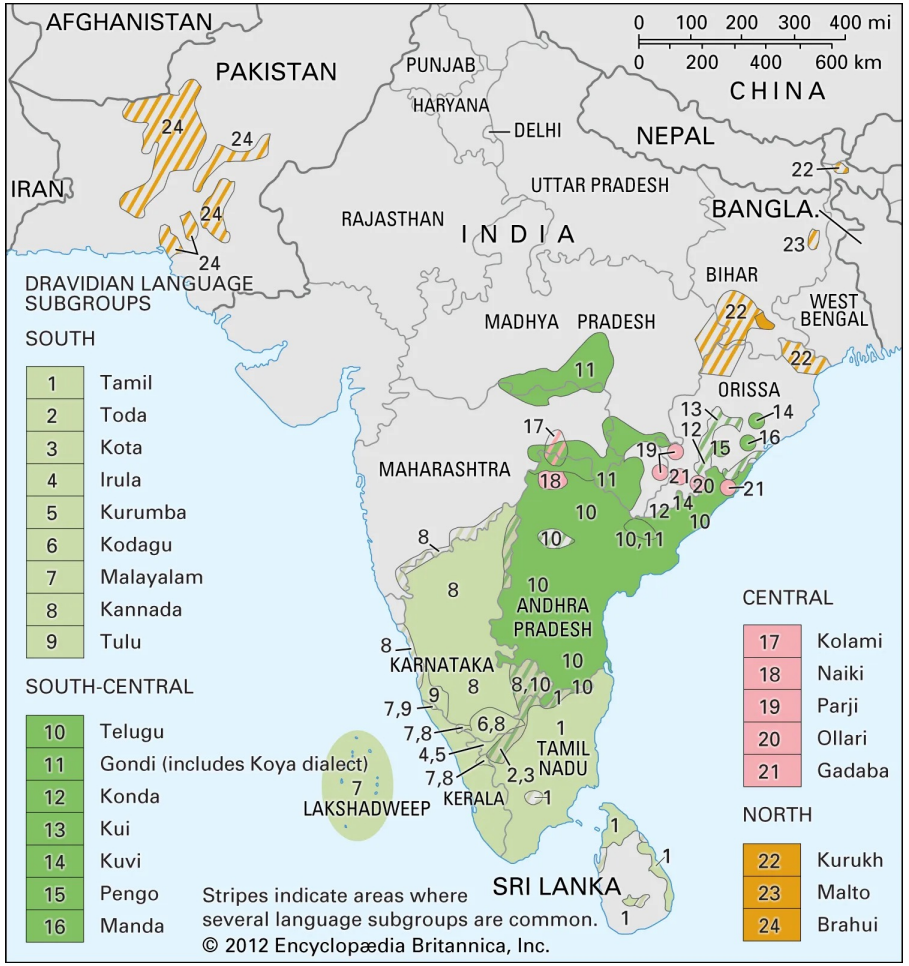
# 1 | Introduction & Phonology

- Ellis and Caldwell
- Classification
- Origins
  - Zagrosian [?]
  - IVC
- Recent work



# 1 | Introduction & Phonology

- Vowels (a, e, i, o, u; ā, ē, ī, ō, ū; ə)
- Centralization
  - Very common in Nilgiri languages
  - More prone before retroflexes
  - Surya's Tamil: வேண்டும் «vēṇṭum» "is wanted" > «vē̆ṇŭm»
- Metaphony
  - Present in SDr, but reversed in some spoken languages
  - *oṯank > Ma. உறங்ங் «uṟaŋŋĭ» "to sleep," sometimes [ʷɔr̪ˠʌŋːɨ]

# 1 | Introduction & Phonology

- Consonants
- Alveolars → literally everything
- Intervocalic lenition (spirantization vs. fl/tapping)

| | (B)L | Dental | Alveolar | RF | AP | Palatal | Velar | Uvular | Glottal |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Stops | *p | *t | *t̠ | *ṭ | *c | *ḱ | *k | *q | |
| Nasals | *m | *n | | *ṇ | | *ñ | | | |
| Liquids | *w | | *r, *l | *ṛ (= *z̠) | | *y | | | |
| Fricative | | | | | | | | | *h |

# 2 | Nominals

- Gender & Number
  - PDr, SCDr: ±male (sg, pl)
  - Telugu, NDr: ±male (sg), ±high (pl)
  - SDr: mfn (sg), ±high (pl)
- Cases
  - Unmarked nominative (maybe *-aN)
  - Accusative (*-en)
  - Dative (*-kk)
  - “Relative” > “Oblique” (*-tt, *-in, *-a)

# 2 | Nominals

- Pronouns & Locutives

| | 1SG | 1PL.E | 1PL.I | 2SG | 2PL | RSG | RPL |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| NOM | *yáhn | *yáhm | *ñáhm | *níhn | *níhm | *táhn | *táhm |
| OBL | *yàhn | *yàhm | *ñàhm | *nìhn | *nìhm | *tàhn | *tàhm |

| | SG.M | SG.N | PL.M | PL.N |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| NOM | *-ant̲ | *-t | *-ar | *-ay |
| OBL | *-an | *-t-an | *-ar | *-at̲t̲ |

# 2 | Nominals

- Numerals
  - Nominalized (derivative) and adjectival (root) forms
  - Nominalized forms slowly replacing adjectival forms

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *ohr | *ihr | *muh | *nāl | *cay | *cahṯ | *ēṛ | *eṇ | *toḷ | *pah |
| *-nṯ | *-aṇṭ | *-nṯ | *-nk | *-nt | *- | *-u | *-tt | *-t | *-t |

# 3 | The Verb

- Inflectional
  - Specific——general (*-ḱ-, *-n-)
  - Completive——incompletive (*-t-, *-a)
  - Affective——effective (*-nk-, *-nc, *-t-, *-p)
  - Imperative, optative, & subjunctive (*-∅, *-k-, *-p-)
  - Durative (*-n-)
- PNGs

| | 1SG | 1PL.E | 1PL.I | 2SG | 2PL | 3SG.M | 3SG.N | 3PL.N | 3PL.M |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Locs. | *-en | *-em | *-am | *-ay | *-ir | *-ant | *-t | *-aw | *-r |
| PNGs | *-k | *-um | *-att | *-ti | | *-i | | | *-pa |

# 3 | The Verb

- Putting it all together: Middle Telugu paradigm «wa-» “to come”

| | 1SG | 1PL | 2SG | 2PL | 3SG, 3PL.N | 3PL.M |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Past | wa-cciti-ni<br>వచ్చితిని | wa-cciti-mi<br>వచ్చితిమి | wa-cciti-wi<br>వచ్చితివి | wa-cciti-ri<br>వచ్చితిరి | wa-cce-nu<br>వచ్చెను | wa-cci-ri<br>వచ్చిరి |
| Present | wa-cce-da-nu<br>వచ్చెదను | wa-cce-da-mu<br>వచ్చెదము | wa-cce-da-wu<br>వచ్చెదవు | wa-cce-da-ru<br>వచ్చెదరు | wa-cce-ḍu-nu<br>వచ్చెడును | wa-cce-da-ru<br>వచ్చెదరు |
| Future | wad-du-nu<br>వద్దును | wad-du-mu<br>వద్దుము | wad-du-vu<br>వద్దువు | wad-du-ru<br>వద్దురు | waccu-nu<br>వచ్చును | wad-du-ru<br>వద్దురు |

# 3 | The Verb

- Converbs
  - Incompletive ⟶ infinitive
  - Completive ⟶ converb
  - Subject governance
- Only one main verb
- ∅ negative < *-ah
  - Past negative – original or innovation?
    Ta. செய்யாதேன்«ceyyātēṉ»
    OMa. ചെയ്യാഞ്ഞേൻ «ceyyāññēṉ» < *ceyy-āy-nt-ēn
    Kui ഗിആതേനു «giātēnu»

# 4 | Adjective & Adverb Derivation

- Adjectives
  - Participle
    - Ta. சிவந்த மண் «civanta maṇ» and சிவக்கு மண் «civakku(m) maṇ», both “red soil”
  - Oblique noun
    - OTu. ವೇಗೊ «vēgo» “speed” in ವೇಗೊಂತಾಯ «vēgon-t(ŭ)-āye» “fast man”
  - True adjectives
    - Very few
    - Some may be archaic verbs (in Tamil)
  - Appellatives
    - “Defective verbs”
    - Tenseless

# 4 | Adjective & Adverb Derivation

- Adverbs
  - Converb
    - OTa. விரை «virai» “to rush” in விரைந்து சென்மதி «viraintŭ ceṉmati» “go quickly!”
  - Noun + converb of “to be”
    - Mp. «-āka», «-āy» in ಸುಖಾಕ ಹವಿತ್ತಾನು «sukʰam-m-āka bʰavittāṉ»
    - OTe. «-ai», «-uṇḍi» in సుఖంబై «sukʰamb-ai» or సుఖంబుండి «sukʰamb-uṇḍi»
    - Ka. «āgi» in ಸುಂದರವಾಗಿ «sundara-(v)-āgi»

# 5 | Syntax

- SOV
  - Tu. ಅಂಬೆ ಮಲ್ತೆ «ŭmbe malte» “he did”
  - Tu. ಅಂಬೆ ಸ್ನಾನ ಮಲ್ತೆ «ŭmbe snāna malte» “he did bath = he bathed”
  - Tu. ಅಂಬೆ ಪೋವೆನಿಂದ್ ಪಣ್ತೆ «ŭmbe pōwɛn-indŭ paṇte» “he said ‘I may go’”
- Commonly zero copula
  - Ta. *என் பெயர் ராமக்ருஷ்ணன்* «eṉ peyar rāmakṛṣṇaṉ», but also…
  - Ta. *என் பெயர் ராமக்ருஷ்ண னாகும்* «eṉ peyar rāmakṛṣṇaṉ ākum»
  - Te. చిరాయువుల్కలిగి «cirāyuvul(u) kaligi», and నిమగ్నులై «nimagnul(u)-ai»

# 5 | Syntax

- Single finite verb
  - Heavy use of converbs
  - “He dances, sings, and sleeps”
    Ka. «avanu āḍi hāḍi oṟaguvanu», and not
    *«avanu āḍuvanu, pāḍuvanu, mattu oṟaguvanu»
- Periphrastic aspectual forms get crazy
  - Ma. «ceyt-āy-iṭṭ-iriññu» “it has been done”
  - Ta. progressive in «s.cvв-koṇṭ(ŭ)-iru» (semantic shift)
  - Ba. progressive in «s.cvв-uṇḍ(ŭ)-iru» (areal influence)

# 5 | Syntax

- Relative clauses
  - Almost exclusively participial phrases
    «pustakam cadiw-i-na koḍuku» in Telugu
    book.ACC read-PST-PTCP boy
  - Subject ambiguity
    «paṇam uḷ(ḷ)-a budd$^{h}$isāli» in BrTa.
    money exist-PTCP intelligent_person
- Correlative clauses
  - However-X… that-X.
    «elli b$^{h}$aktaru karedar(u)-allē odaguvan(u)-ō» in Kannada
    “he will assist wherever devotees call [for him]”

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